

Skills Summary

Missing Addends Within 20

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Count on with a ten-frame

Model:

part + $\boxed{?}$ = whole. The counters you can see are the **known part**; the total you want is the **whole**.

- Start at the known part. Do *not* say it as your first count.
- Count on one at a time until you say the whole. The number of counts is the missing addend.

Example: $7 + \underline{\quad} = 12$

Step 1. The known part is 7 and the whole is 12, so count on from 7 up to 12 and keep track of how many counts.

Step 2. 8, 9, 10, 11, 12 — five counts, so the missing addend is **5**.

Try it: $8 + \underline{\quad} = 15$

check: 7

Skill 2 — Subtract to find the part

Rule:

whole – known part = missing part.

Every missing-addend equation can be rewritten as a subtraction, and the subtraction is usually faster when the missing part is large.

Example: $\underline{\quad} + 9 = 17$

Step 1. The whole is 17 and one part is 9, so take the known part away from the whole instead of counting one by one.

Step 2. $17 - 9 = 8$, and the check $9 + 8 = 17$ works, so the missing part is **8**.

Try it: $\underline{\quad} + 4 = 13$

check: 6

Skill 3 — Missing addends in a story

How to set it up:

- Find the **whole**: the number the story wants *in all*.
- Find the **known part**: what the person already has.
- Write part + $\boxed{?}$ = whole, then subtract. Answer with the unit from the story.

Example: Ben has 6 stickers. He wants 14 stickers in all. How many more?

Step 1. “In all” names the whole (14 stickers) and “has” names the known part (6 stickers), so this is $6 + ? = 14$.

Step 2. $14 - 6 = 8$, and $6 + 8 = 14$ checks, so Ben needs **8** more stickers.

Try it: Rosa has 9 shells and wants 16 shells in all. How many more shells?

✓ check

(!) Watch out: The two numbers you can see are *not* both parts. The bigger one is the whole, so do not add them. In $5 + ? = 13$ the answer is $13 - 5 = 8$, never $5 + 13$.